

Chapter 1: The Indian Subcontinent and History

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. Answer the following in one sentence:

Q1.) What is history?

History is a coherent account of the significant past events in the progress of human culture.

Q2.) Where do human settlements flourish?

Human settlements have flourished wherever the means of living are plentiful.

Q3.) What do the people in the hilly region depend on for their food?

In the hilly regions, people depend more on hunting and gathering for their food.

Q4.) Which was the earliest civilization in India?

The Harappan civilization was the earliest civilization in India.

2. Answer the following questions in short:

Q1.) What does human life depend on?

Human life in any region depends to a large extent on its geographical characteristics, which directly influence diet, clothing, housing, and occupations.

Q2.) What features of our surroundings form the means of our livelihood?

The climate, rainfall, agricultural produce, flora, and fauna of the region where we live form the source or means of our livelihood.

Q3.) Which region is known as the Indian subcontinent?

Afghanistan, Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and India together form the region known as South Asia. Considering the expanse and significance of India in this region, it is also known as the Indian subcontinent.

3. Give reasons:

Q1.) There is a close relation between history and geography.

1. Time, place, society, and individuals are the four major pillars without which history cannot be written.
2. Of these four components, 'place' is directly related to geography or geographical conditions.
3. This makes history and geography inseparable, that is, very closely related.

Q2.) People are forced to leave their settlements.

1. Sometimes factors like degradation of the environment, drought, invasion, or scarcity of natural resources occur.
2. Therefore, when means of livelihood dwindle, people are forced to leave their settlements in their fight for survival.

4. Explain the difference in the human life in the hilly regions and that on the plains:

Human Life in the Hilly Regions	Human Life on the Plains
(1) Human life is strenuous and physically demanding.	(1) Life is comparatively easier and more comfortable.
(2) Land is not fertile, so agriculture is limited.	(2) Land is very fertile, so extensive agriculture is carried on.
(3) Food grains and vegetables are scarce.	(3) Food grains and vegetables are found in plenty.
(4) People depend more on hunting and gathering for food.	(4) People depend primarily on farming and settled occupations.

5. Observe the physical map of India and answer the questions based on it:

Q1.) Which mountain ranges lie in the north of India?

The Hindukush and the Himalayan mountain ranges lie in the north of India.

Q2.) Which are the routes to India from the north-east?

The routes to India from the north-east are through mountain passes and river valleys, as well as sea routes along the eastern coast.

Q3.) Where do the Ganga and Brahmaputra meet?

The Ganga and Brahmaputra meet in Bangladesh.

Q4.) Name the islands to the east of the Indian peninsula.

The Andaman and Nicobar islands are the Indian islands located to the east of the Indian peninsula.

Q5.) In which part of India do we see the Thar Desert?

We see the Thar Desert in the north-western part of India.